

# The Recycled Robot Friend

A bit of a stretch · Indoors · Grown-up nearby · Ages 5–10 · 35 min

Brought to you by Mateo — “If it can be stacked, it can be a city.”

Give the recycling bin a second job and end up with a robot that has a name and a personality.

## WHAT YOU NEED

- Clean tins, tubs, boxes, and lids
- Tape and glue
- Markers
- Foil, string, and bottle caps for details

## BEFORE YOU START

Only use clean containers, and nothing with a sharp cut edge.

A grown-up checks every tin before it goes in the pile.

## How to make it

- 1 Empty the clean recycling onto a towel and sort it into big, medium, and small.
- 2 Pick your biggest piece for the body and stand it up. Everything else attaches to this.
- 3 Add a head, then arms, then legs. Test after each part that the robot still stands.
- 4 Give it a face using bottle caps and lids. The eyes decide the whole personality, so try three sets before you commit.
- 5 Add one detail that tells you what your robot is for: a scoop, an antenna, a pocket.
- 6 Name it and write a three-sentence introduction: what it is called, what it does, and what it is afraid of.

## TALK ABOUT IT

Which piece of rubbish turned out to be the most useful, and what made it good?

## TRY THIS TOO

Build a second robot from only the pieces the first one rejected, and introduce them to each other.

## DID YOU KNOW? · RECYCLING & REUSE

Recycling means a material gets used again instead of thrown away. Every tin and tub in your robot was on its way to becoming something else. Reusing something as it is takes even less energy than melting it down, which is why building with it counts too.